Week 8 | Friday checks

2026-12-11 | Three brief items per check. Record accuracy and support separately.

Spelling

Use three words explicitly taught from each learner's current HMH sound-spelling pattern. Say the word, use it in a sentence, repeat it. Record encoding separately from supported pattern recognition. Words: _____ _____ _____.

Grade 3 reading | Little Penguins

Use the actual book, with the planned access supports.

1. Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?

Teacher key: Names or points to the character, setting or event.

2. What does a character do about the problem?

Teacher key: Shows a character action in the selected scene.

3. What happens next or at the end?

Teacher key: Sequences the next or ending event from the book.

Grade 4 reading | Little Penguins

Use the actual book, with the planned access supports.

1. What problem or important event is shown in this scene?

Teacher key: Identifies a problem or important event actually shown.

2. What does a character do, and why?

Teacher key: Explains a character action or choice with support.

3. How does that action affect the result? Show the page or illustration.

Teacher key: Connects the action to the result using page evidence.

Math | Week 8

Grade 3

3.3H

1. Compare one half and one fourth.

2. Compare three fourths and one fourth.

3. Show that two fourths and one half are equal.

Teacher key

1/2 greater; 3/4 greater; equal

Grade 4

4.3A | 4.3B | 4.3E

1. Build 3/4 in two ways as a sum of same-denominator fractions; record both equations.

2. Model 3/4 - 1/4 and name the result.

3. Build 1 whole plus 1/2 from halves and record 1/2 + 1/2 + 1/2.

Teacher key

1/4 + 2/4 and 1/4 + 1/4 + 1/4; 2/4 (or 1/2); 3/2 = 1 1/2.

Science | Week 8

Experiment replaces the separate science quiz

Use materials connected to Little Penguins: Explore how clothing materials help keep a pretend penguin warm; observe and compare the test safely. Record a prediction, three observations and one evidence-based conclusion.

Grade 3

3.8A | 3.8B

1. Plan slow and faster runs of the same car into the same foam block; name what stays the same.
2. Run and repeat the comparison, resetting the block. Identify observed speed and block movement.
3. Use the observed effect on the block to explain how speed relates to mechanical energy.

Teacher key

Keeps car/block/surface/collision point fixed; records actual observations; faster motion of the same object has more mechanical energy, supported by the observed greater effect. Recheck setup if results are inconsistent.

Grade 4

4.7

1. Test the same car on smooth board and felt.
2. Describe a repeatable difference.
3. Identify friction as the force related to slowing.

Teacher key

Controlled surface test; plausible observed difference; friction

Additional product: Social studies

Writing: one clear idea, relevant detail/reason and understandable communication. Social studies: a correct person/event or community claim, relevant source evidence and supported connection. Score each criterion 0/1 with prompts noted; apply school grading rules.